



From paper to slides

Three ways to build a deck, and an AI one that says only what the paper says

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Who I am



Niccolò Salvini, PhD · Adjunct Professor

- **Economics**, Florence
- **MSc, Statistical and Actuarial Sciences**, Milan
- **PhD, Healthcare Data Science**, Rome
- **Founder, Intuo**: data pipelines and AI for companies
- **Adjunct Professor**: Università Cattolica, and ESE

The next 55 minutes

0–12	Three ways to build a deck	PowerPoint · LaTeX Beamer · HTML
12–16	Gemini Notebook in one minute, then you launch three decks	the same article, three prompts
16–35	Tricks, while your decks are generating	sources, citations, theme, Rivedi
35–50	Compare A · B · C, keep the best slides	one change at a time
50–55	Three rules to take home	

One article for everyone: Van Ooijen, *Resilient Matters: The Cathedral of Syracuse as an Architectural Palimpsest*, Architectural Histories, 2019.

PART 1

Three ways to build a deck

Three families, one question: who decides the layout?

	SLIDES APP	LATEX BEAMER	HTML
You write in	the slide itself	<code>.tex</code> code	Markdown
You get	<code>.pptx</code> → PDF	PDF	a web page
The theme lives in	the master slide	a <code>.sty</code> file	a <code>.scss</code> file
Maths, references	painful	native	good (KaTeX, BibTeX)
Video, live charts, maps	video only	almost none	everything a browser shows
Good for	quick decks, templates you are given	papers, formulas, conferences in STEM	teaching, interactive material

Tools: PowerPoint, Keynote, Google Slides · Beamer on Overleaf · Quarto + reveal.js, Slidev, Marp.

You are looking at HTML right now

This deck is a **Markdown file** rendered by **Quarto** into a **reveal.js** web page.

```
1 ## You are looking at HTML right now
2
3 This deck is a **Markdown file** rendered by.
4
5 - a bullet is a dash
6 - a picture is 
```

`quarto render deck.qmd` → `deck.html` →
open in any browser, or print to PDF.

The look is one file. `unipg.scss` holds four colours read from `unipg.it` and one font:

 `#27348B` blue  `#E30613` red 
`#8D8F95` grey `#E8E8E8` light grey **Roboto**

Change the file, every slide changes. Keep this in mind: in Part 2 we give the same five values to Gemini.

A real course deck, mapped to its technology



WHAT YOU SEE

WHAT MAKES IT

text, columns, tables

Markdown → Pandoc

slides, transitions, speaker view

reveal.js

animations

manim (Python) → MP4

charts, diagrams

Python → SVG

colours, fonts

one `.scss` file

hosting

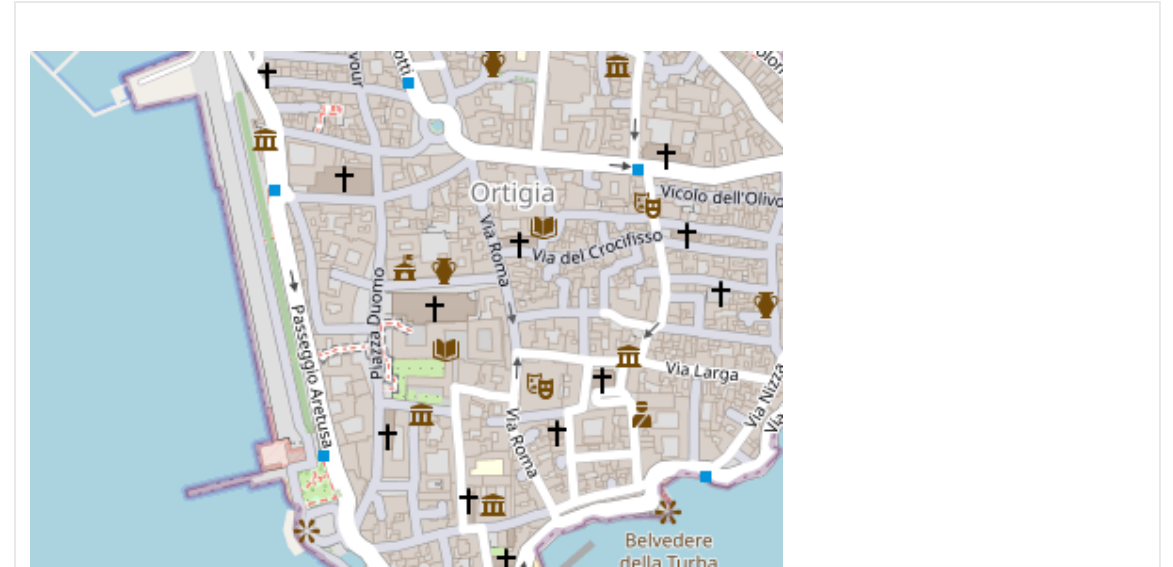
GitHub Pages

Click to open it live: 49 slides, Markdown + manim + SVG

Inside an HTML slide you can put anything a browser shows



A manim animation, embedded as a video



A live map: the Cathedral of Syracuse, today's article

Also: an interactive chart, a web page, a form, a notebook, a 3D model. In a PDF none of this moves.

The LaTeX route: Beamer

```
1 \documentclass[aspectratio=169]{beamer}
2 \usetheme{default} % or the conference .s
3 \definecolor{unipg}{HTML}{27348B}
4 \setbeamercolor{frametitle}{fg=unipg}
5
6 \begin{document}
7 \begin{frame}{Architectural resilience may rely
8             on continuous adaptation}
9   \includegraphics[height=.6\textheight]{fig3}
10  \href{https://doi.org/10.5334/ah.65}{Van Ooijen}
11 \end{frame}
12 \end{document}
```

Why people use it: formulas, `\cite`, the conference asks for it, the output is one stable PDF.

What you can embed: TikZ and pgfplots drawings, code listings, links, step-by-step overlays (`\pause`, `\only`), frame-by-frame animation with the `animate` package.

What you cannot really embed: video, live maps, anything interactive.

Overleaf compiles it in the browser. Many conferences give you a `.sty` theme: that file is the “theme” we talk about next.

Every route has the same idea: the theme is one place

ROUTE	WHERE THE LOOK LIVES	WHAT YOU CHANGE FOR A NEW CONFERENCE
Slides app	slide master / template	open their .potx
Beamer	.sty or preamble	\usetheme{conf}
HTML	.scss	four hex codes and a font
Gemini Notebook	the prompt	four hex codes and a font, written in words

An AI tool has no theme file. The prompt *is* the theme file.

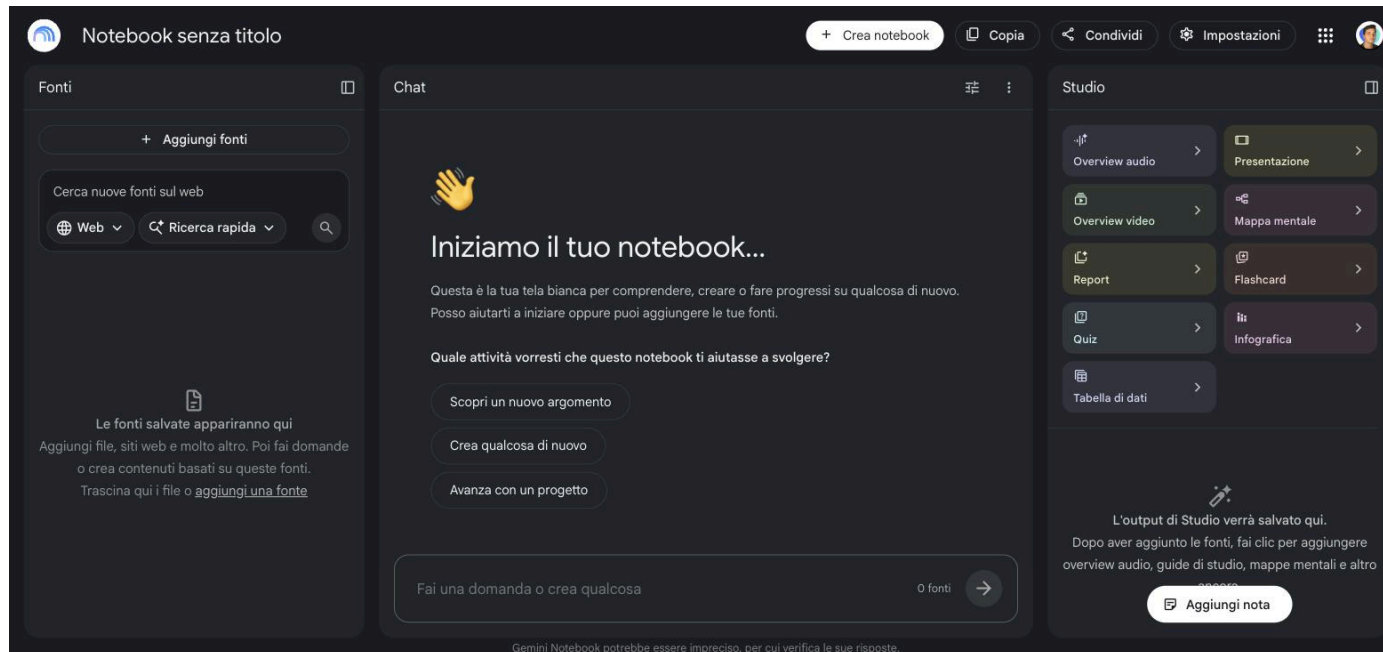
PART 2

One article, three decks, one tool

One rule for the hour

We work only on what is uploaded. If the model says something and cannot show where it is in the text, for us it does not exist.

The tool in one minute



- **Sources**, left: the only thing the model reads
- **Chat**, centre: where you check, every sentence has a number
- **Studio**, right: where decks are made

notebook.google.com, with your **@unipg.it** account.

The source: the PDF, checked in 30 seconds

Before uploading any PDF: select a line, copy it, paste it somewhere.

ON SCREEN	WHAT THE MACHINE READS
Architectural Histories	\$UFKLWHFWXUDO +LVWRULHV
Resilient Matters: The Cathedral...	Resilient Matters: The Cathedral...

That is today's article: the journal logo is unreadable, the body text is fine.

If the text comes out garbled, the model **will still answer**, with something plausible. It never says it could not read.

Today: *Add source* → *Websites* → paste the **direct PDF link**:

journal.eahn.org/article/7590/galley/21444/download/

The article page itself imports badly (menus, cookie banners). The direct PDF link imports clean.

Three prompts, one change at a time

	PROMPT	WHAT CHANGES	WHAT IT ISOLATES
A	<i>"Create a 7-slide presentation on this article for a non-specialist academic audience."</i>	nothing	what the tool does alone
B	A + content rules : only what is in the text, titles as claims, keep the author's caution, no generated images, last slide = limits	the content	hallucination
C	B + the UNIPG theme : four hex codes, Roboto, a blue rule under titles, space for the logo	only the look	theme

A→B compares content with the look free. B→C compares the look with the content fixed. The full prompts are on the materials page: copy, don't retype.

You get three decks a day. Spend them on purpose.

3 presentations per account per day

measured this morning on an @unipg.it account: the fourth attempt says *“Hai raggiunto il limite giornaliero di slide”*.

- A deck takes **about 7 minutes**, three launched together finish together.
- **Rivedi** (editing a deck) does **not** count toward the three: about 2 minutes for one slide, 15 for all seven.
- The quota did not come back at 9:00 this morning. Plan as if it is gone for the day.
- So: **A, B, C once each**. Everything after that is Rivedi.

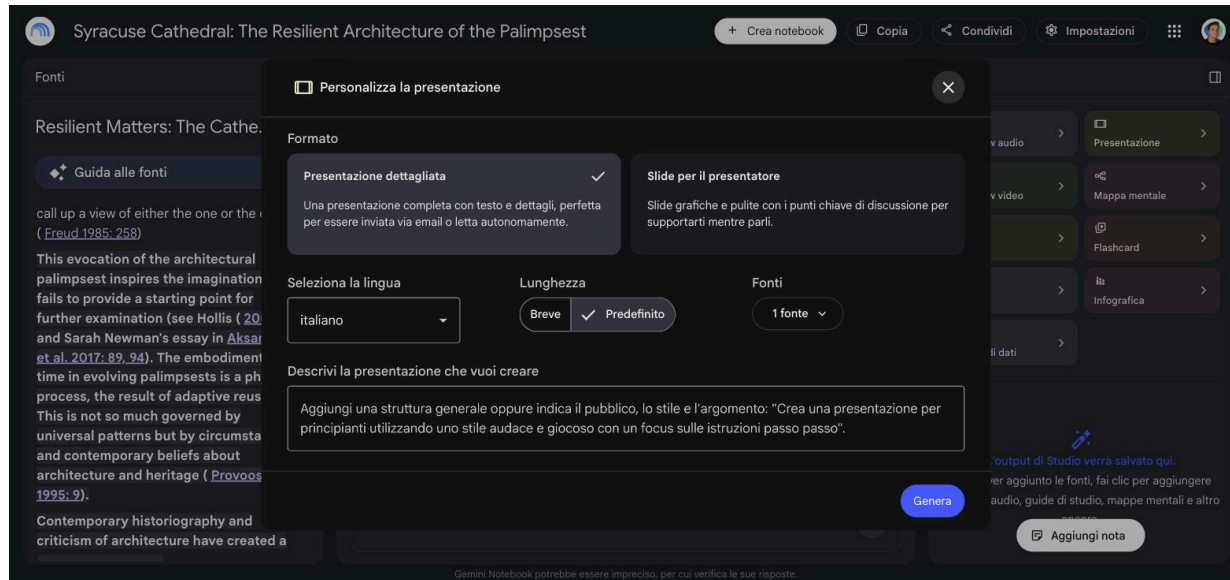
Everything you need to copy is on one page



[niccolosalvini.github.io/
unipg_ai_workshop](https://niccolosalvini.github.io/unipg_ai_workshop)

- the direct link to the article
- prompts **A**, **B**, **C** with a copy button
- the five questions for the comparison, Rivedi examples
- these slides, and the decks generated this morning

Launch now: Studio → Presentation → customise



1 Format: **Presenter slides**, the right-hand card

2 Language: **English**

3 Paste prompt **A** → *Genera*

4 Reopen, same settings, prompt **B** → *Genera*

5 Reopen, prompt **C** → *Genera*

The dialog forgets format and language every time. Set them again.

Then close it. **Don't watch the spinner.**

PART 3

Tricks, while your decks are generating

Trick 1 · The number is the only thing that lets you trust

Syracuse Cathedral: The Resilient Architecture of the Palimpsest

Fonti

Resilient Matters: The Cathed... [Link]

Guida alle fonti

as an Architectural Palimpsest | Architectural Histories

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Chat

Architecture 4 e Conclusion 5 (p. 2)

2. Tesi dell'autrice

L'adozione della lente del palinsesto architettonico, che rivela edifici stratificati nella loro natura diacronica, è un edificio di adattarsi continuamente a nuove esigenze, ma ne rafforza il significato. 1

Sezione / Pagina: Abstract 1, The Palimpsest in Architecture 6 e Conclusion 5 7 (p. 26).

3. Claim a sostegno della tesi

1. La resilienza architettonica non deriva dalla sua capacità materiale di trasformarsi, ma dalle esigenze storiche, sociali e culturali. 6

Sezione / Pagina: Introduction 8, The Palimpsest in Architecture 6 e Conclusion 7 (p. 26).

2. A differenza del palinsesto paleografico, in cui il testo sottostante veniva cancellato, qui il testo sottostante veniva preservato.

Fai una domanda o crea qualcosa 1 fonte →

Resilient Matters: The Cathedral of Syracuse as an Architectural Palimpsest | Architectural Histories

This evocation of the architectural palimpsest inspires the imagination, but fails to provide a starting point for further examination (see Hollis (2009) and Sarah Newman's essay in [Aksamija et al. 2017: 89, 94](#)). The embodiment of time in evolving palimpsests is a physical process, the result of adaptive reuse. This is not so much governed by universal patterns but by circumstances and contemporary beliefs about architecture and heritage ([Provoost 1995: 9](#)).

Contemporary historiography and criticism of architecture

Visualizza fonte

Studio

Overview audio > Presentazione >

Overview video > Mappa mentale >

Report > Flashcard >

Quiz > Infografica >

Tabella di dati >

L'output di Studio verrà salvato qui.

Dopo aver aggiunto le fonti, fai clic per aggiungere overview audio, guide di studio, mappe mentali e altro.

Aggiungi nota

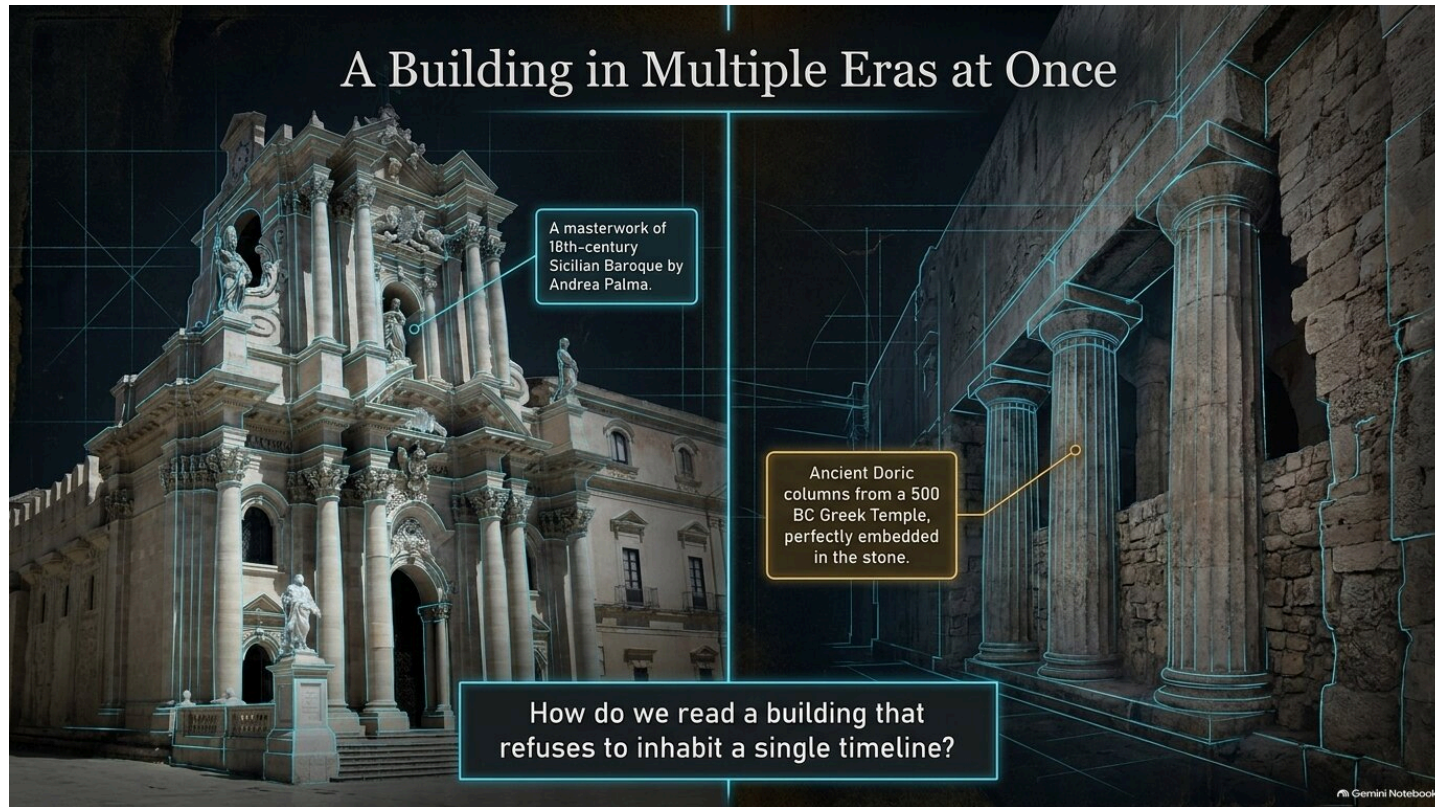
Gemini Notebook potrebbe essere impreciso, per cui verifica le sue risposte.

In the chat, every sentence carries a number. **Click it**: the passage of the article opens.

If the passage says less than the sentence, the sentence does not go on a slide.

Ask in chat: *"What are the three claims the thesis rests on? Cite the page for each."* Then click every number.

Trick 2 · Without rules, the tool illustrates. Here is deck A.



The captions are **right**: 500 BC, Andrea Palma, 18th-century Baroque are all in the article.

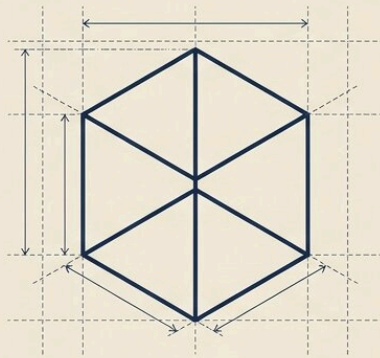
The **picture is not**. It is a generated cathedral: a document of a building that does not look like that.

In a talk, a generated photo of a real place reads as evidence.

Trick 3 · Rules work on content. Here is deck B.

Architectural resilience may rely on continuous material adaptation rather than physical immutability.

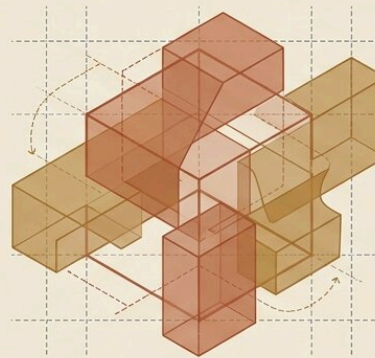
Model A (The Immutable Ideal)



Immutable Ideal

Advanced since the Renaissance, placing structures at risk of becoming obsolete.

Model B (The Resilient Reality)



Resilient Reality

Staying in sync with changing historical circumstances, economic conditions, and social values.

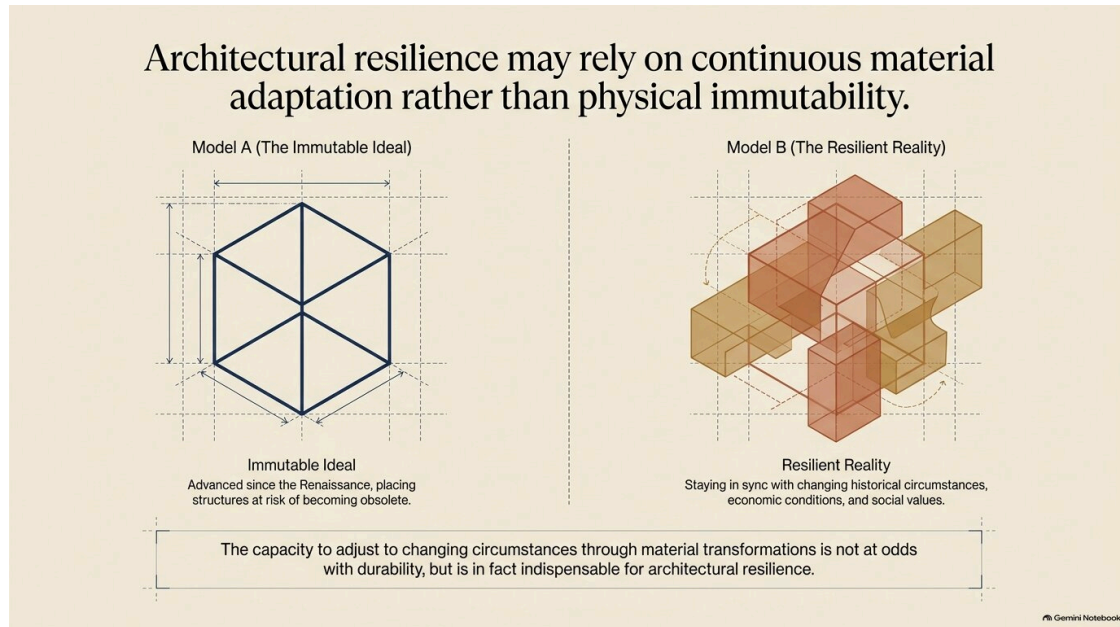
The capacity to adjust to changing circumstances through material transformations is not at odds with durability, but is in fact indispensable for architectural resilience.

Gemini Notebook

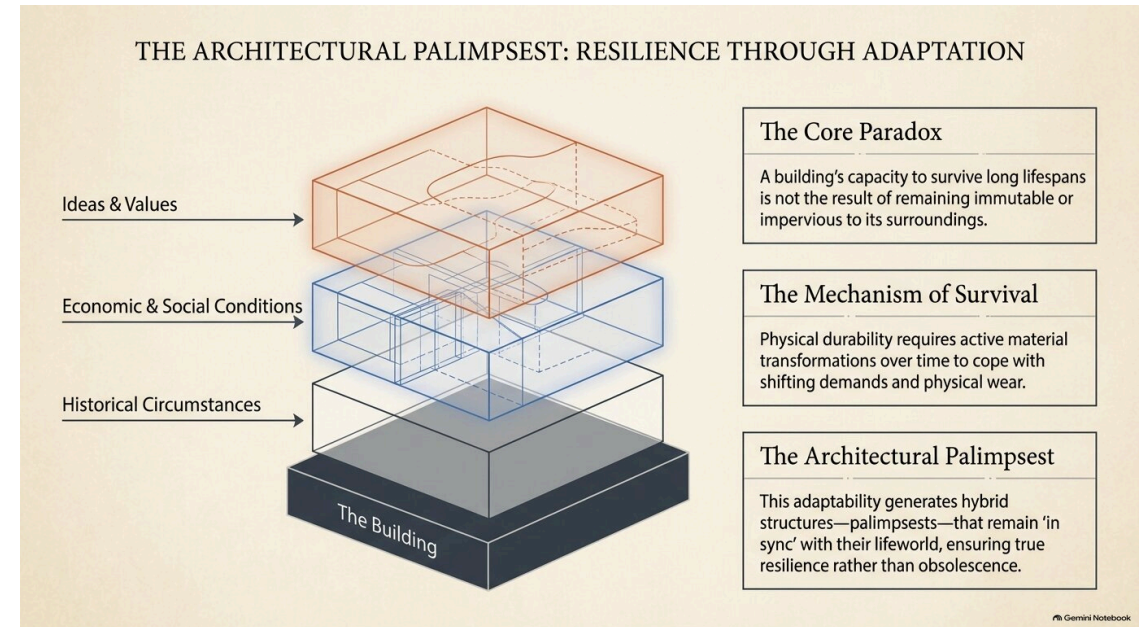
- the title is **a claim**, not a topic
- it keeps the author's caution: "*may rely*"
- diagrams instead of photos
- the last slide is the author's limits

Same article, same tool, ten more lines of prompt.

Be honest about this: the same prompt never gives the same deck



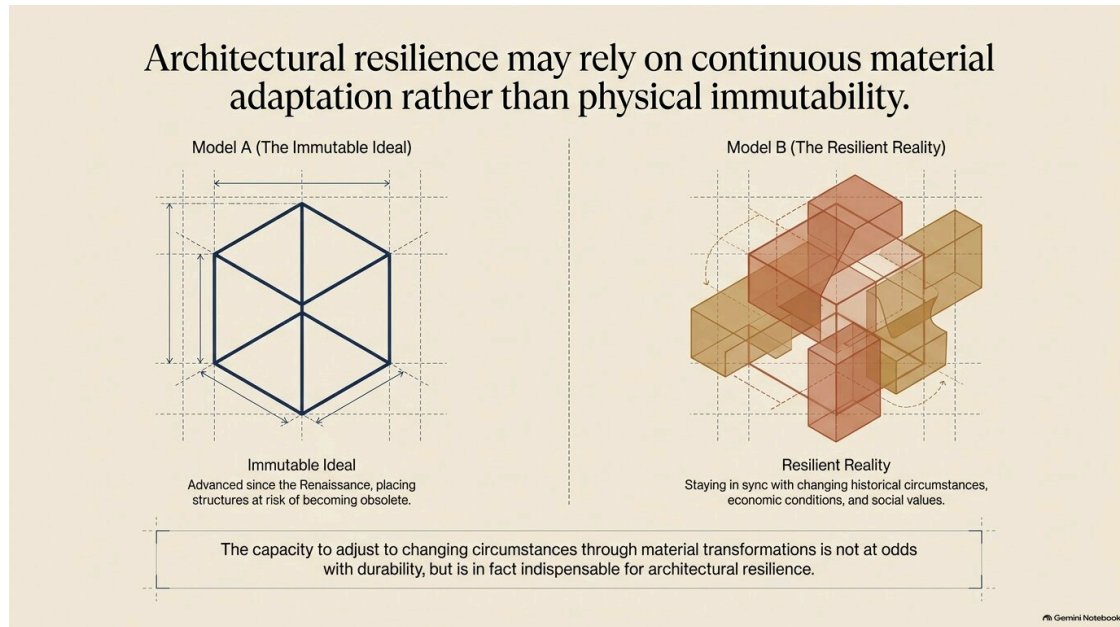
Prompt B, @unipg.it account, 08:27



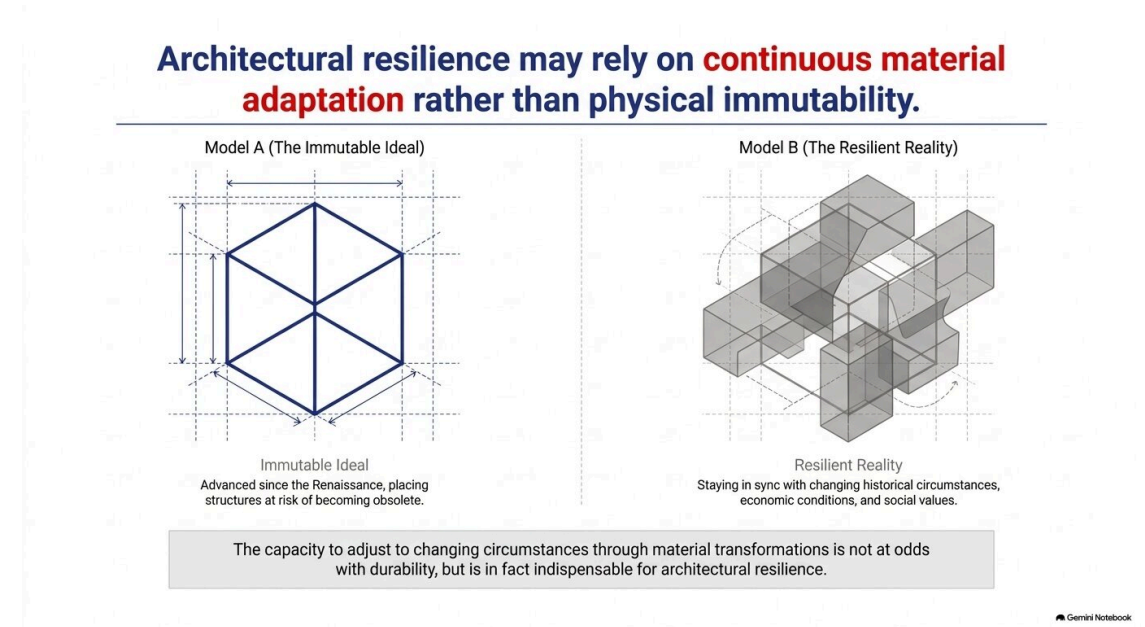
Prompt B, identical, another account, 08:20. The title is a topic label again.

Style you can steer. Structure you cannot reproduce. Every generation is a new draw. That is why we compare decks and keep slides, instead of hoping the next run is the right one.

Trick 4 · A theme is hex codes and a font, not adjectives



Deck B



Deck B + the UNIPG theme: #27348B, #E30613, #8D8F95, #E8E8E8, Roboto, a blue rule.

Same words.

“**Elegant, institutional, blue**” gives a different blue every time. **#27348B, Roboto** gives the same one. Your conference’s codes are in its template (.potx, .sty), its website CSS (Inspect), or its logo .svg (fill="#...").

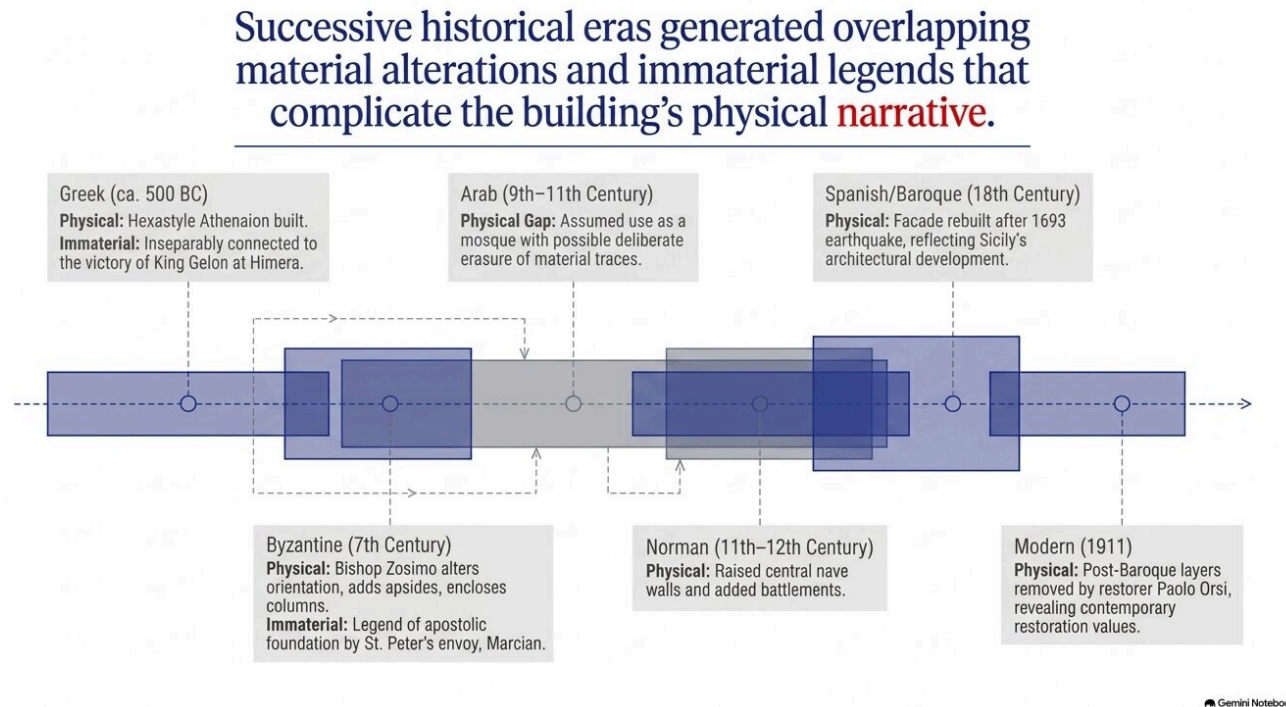
Check that the theme held on every slide, not only the first

Slides 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 7: blue sans-serif titles, one red word.

Slide 4: **serif, black title**, as in deck B. The theme did not reach it.

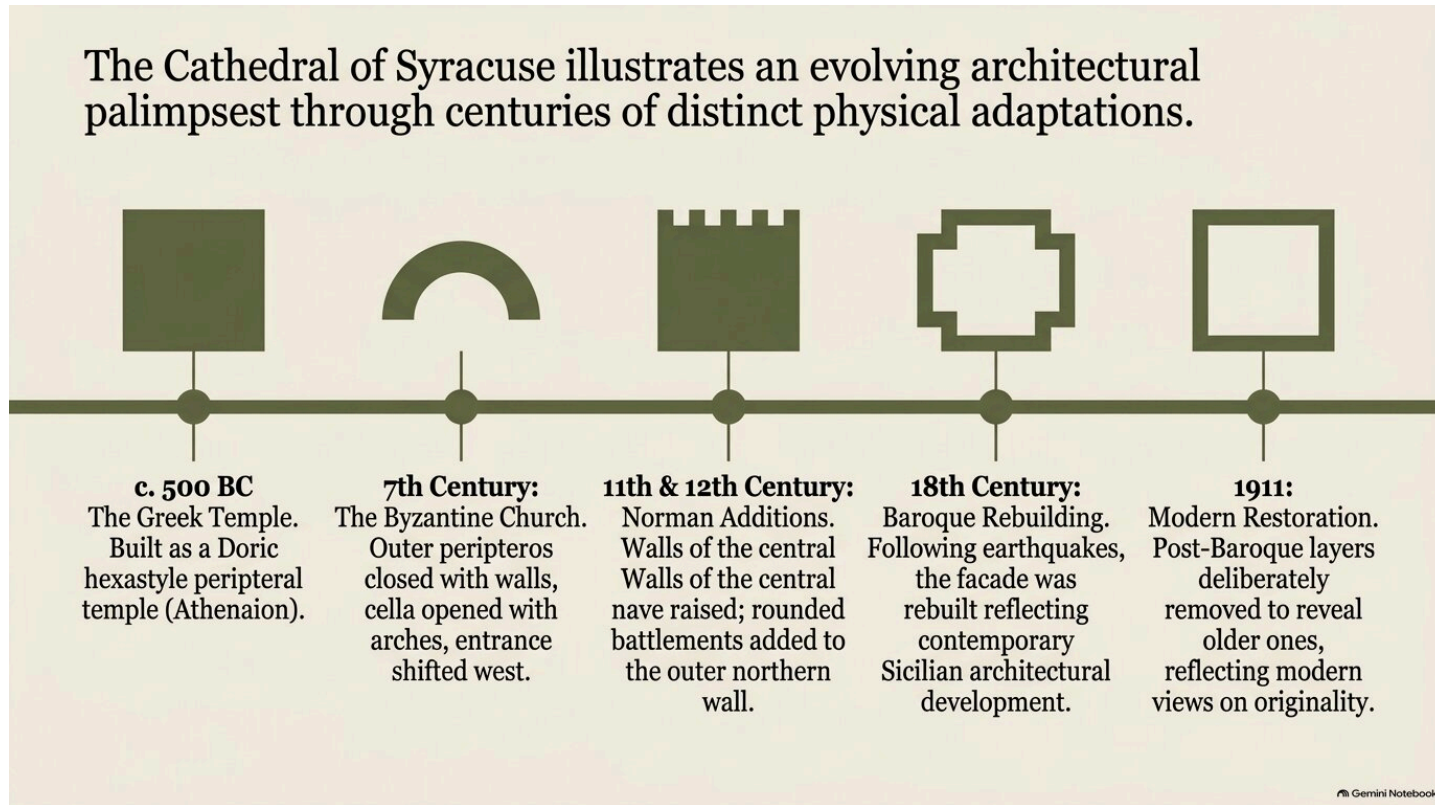
Also: grey boxes in the top-right corner, where we asked for *empty*.

Fix: Rivedi on slide 4 alone, same instruction. One slide, two minutes.



Slide 4 of the same deck

Trick 5 · Read the text inside the picture



Generated slides are **images** (PNG, 1376×768), even in the **.pptx** download: seven pictures, no text boxes. The text is drawn, not typed.

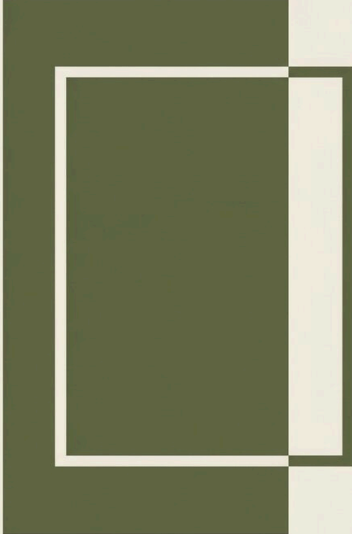
Look at the third column: “*Walls of the central **Walls of the central** nave raised*”.

No spell-checker, no copy-paste, no search. You read every slide yourself, or nobody does.

Trick 6 · Rivedi: one slide, one instruction

Architectural palimpsests express historicity and embody resilience through continuous material transformations.

- Buildings generally have **long lifespans**, requiring them to adjust to changing surroundings, economic conditions, and physical wear and tear.
- The ability to **adapt** to changing circumstances is at odds with the theoretical ideal of an immutable building, but it is indispensable for architectural **resilience**.
- Buildings that physically show these different stages and layers of adaptation are characterized as **architectural palimpsests**.

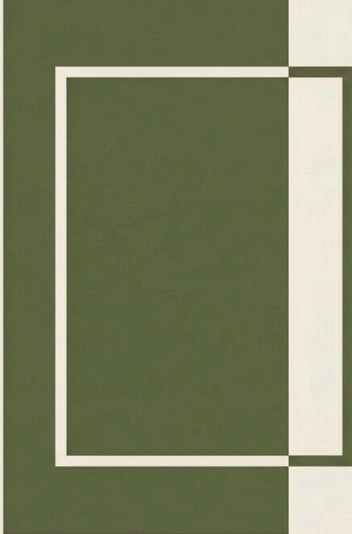


Gemini Notebook

Before

Architectural palimpsests show historicity and resilience through material transformations.

- Buildings generally have **long lifespans**, requiring them to adjust to changing surroundings, economic conditions, and physical wear and tear.
- The ability to **adapt** to changing circumstances is at odds with the theoretical ideal of an immutable building, but it is indispensable for architectural **resilience**.
- Buildings that physically show these different stages and layers of adaptation are characterized as **architectural palimpsests**.



Gemini Notebook

After: "Shorten the title to at most 10 words, keeping its meaning. Keep layout, colours and text exactly as they are."

Open the deck → **Rivedi** → click a slide → write one instruction → *Genera presentazione rivista*. It makes a **copy** ("(2)"), the original stays. About 2 minutes, and it does not use your daily three.

Rivedi fixes form. The chat fixes content.

Rivedi is good for

- shorter title, dictated title
- remove a bullet list, split a slide
- a colour, a font, alignment
- *“keep layout and image”*

Rivedi does not read the sources

- it cannot check if a claim is true
- it can make a wrong claim sound better
- what is *said* is fixed in chat, with the citations open, then you regenerate

PART 4

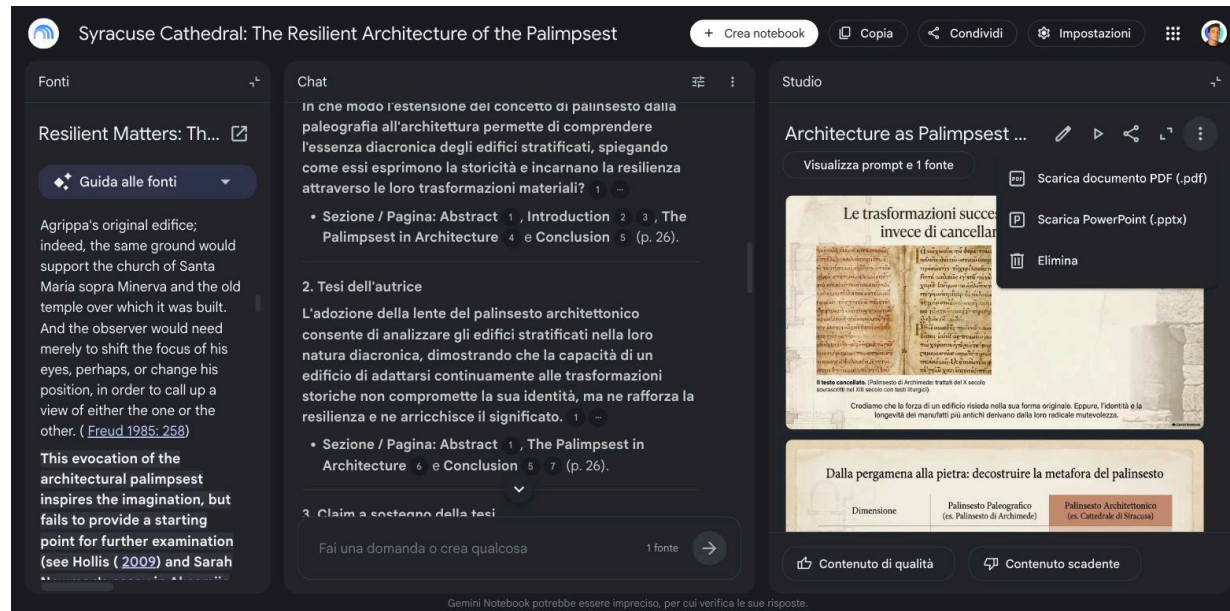
Compare, keep, export

Put A, B and C side by side, and look for five things

	QUESTION	WHERE IT USUALLY SHOWS UP
1	Is there a picture of a real place or person the tool made up?	A
2	Is there a number or date you cannot find in the article?	A
3	Is a title a topic instead of a claim ?	anywhere, even B
4	Does a verb go stronger than the text : <i>suggests</i> → <i>proves</i> ?	A, sometimes B
5	Did the theme hold on every slide, or only on the first?	C

Point 4 is the one that matters in research. Look at the verbs.

Keep the best slides, fix them one by one, export



1. Pick **one deck to keep**, usually C.
2. For each slide that fails the five questions: **Rivedi**, one instruction per slide.
3. If a slide from A or B is better: say so in Rivedi (*“replace slide 4 with a timeline of...”*). The tool cannot paste across decks.
4. **:** → **Scarica** → **PDF**. Export every version you like: versions are free, you cannot rerun one.

Three rules to take home

1. **The prompt is the theme file.** Hex codes and a font, not adjectives. Constraints, not wishes: what you do not forbid, the tool does.
2. **Rivedi fixes form, the chat fixes content.** Rivedi does not read the sources.
3. **Every deck is a draw.** Export it, read every slide, keep the good ones. Versions are free, trust is not.

Materials, slides and example decks: niccolosalvini.github.io/unipg_ai_workshop. When you use it for real: declare it. *"Slides drafted with Gemini Notebook from the author's article, checked and edited by the author."* Generated images carry a visible and an invisible watermark.